



# Draft Agricultural Compliance Statement

---

Walmer Housing Development on Erf 11305,  
Port Elizabeth, Eastern Cape.

**Prepared for:**

Mr Sive Mlamla  
Abantu Environmental Services  
E-mail: [info@abantuenvironmental.co.za](mailto:info@abantuenvironmental.co.za)

**Date submitted:** 5 August 2026

**Mr Roy de Kock M.Sc (Pri.Nat.Sc.)**  
*Agricultural specialist*  
**BlueLeaf Environmental (Pty) Ltd.**  
Cell: +27 76 281 9660  
Email: [roy@blueleafenviro.co.za](mailto:roy@blueleafenviro.co.za)

**Port Elizabeth:**  
38 Tulip Avenue  
Sunridge Park  
Port Elizabeth  
6045

**East London:**  
163 Cowrie Crescent  
Cove Rock Country Estate  
East London  
5213

## Table of Contents

---

|                                               |           |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>1. Declaration of independence .....</b>   | <b>3</b>  |
| <b>2. Expertise of specialist .....</b>       | <b>4</b>  |
| <b>3. Introduction .....</b>                  | <b>6</b>  |
| <b>4. Site analysis .....</b>                 | <b>10</b> |
| 4.1 Site Sensitivity Verification .....       | 10        |
| 4.2 Vegetation .....                          | 11        |
| 4.3 Topography .....                          | 12        |
| 4.4 Geology and soils .....                   | 13        |
| 4.5 Land capability .....                     | 13        |
| <b>5. Site sensitivity verification .....</b> | <b>15</b> |
| <b>6. Reference .....</b>                     | <b>16</b> |

## 1. Declaration of independence

---

I, Roy de Kock as duly authorised representative of BlueLeaf Environmental (Pty) Ltd, hereby confirm my independence (as well as that of BlueLeaf) as a specialist and declare that neither I nor BlueLeaf have any interest, be it business, financial, personal or other, in any proposed activity, application or appeal in respect of which Habitat Link was appointed as environmental assessment practitioner in terms of the National Environmental Management Act, 1998 (Act No. 107 of 1998), other than fair remuneration for work performed, specifically in connection with the Agricultural Compliance Statement for the proposed housing development on erf 11305, Walmer, Port Elizabeth in the Eastern Cape Province. I further declare that I am confident in the results of the studies undertaken and conclusions drawn because of it – as is described in this report.



---

Full Name: Roy de Kock

**Title / Position:** Agricultural specialist

**Qualification(s):** BSc (Hons) Geology; MSc Botany; Candidate PhD Botany

**Experience (years/ months):** 19 years

**Registration(s):** SACNASP (400216/16)

**Tel:** +27 76 281 9660

**Email:** roy@blueleafenviro.co.za

## 2. Expertise of specialist

Roy has over 19 years' experience in environmental consulting and specialist services in the Eastern Cape. Various projects throughout South Africa as well as Africa at large has also been undertaken. Projects include baseline studies, impact assessments and compliance auditing for various large-scale projects including numerous wind farms, roads (National and Provincial), and infrastructure development projects. Roy has also conducted numerous specialist studies including but not limited to Ecological and Botanical assessments, Biodiversity studies, Plant and Animal Search and Rescue, Fauna and Flora permits, Aquatic Assessments, Agricultural and Soil Assessments and Environmental and Venomous animals training workshops.

Roy holds a BSc Honours in Geology and an MSc in Botany from the Nelson Mandela University in Port Elizabeth. He is currently busy with his PhD (Doctorate degree) in Botany and Soil Science. He has over 19 years' experience in the environmental consulting focussing on Ecological and Agricultural Assessments, Geological and Geotechnical analysis, Environmental Management Plans, mining applications and various environmental impact studies.

Roy is a registered as a professional natural scientist (Pri.Sci.Nat.) with SACNASP (Registration nr: 400216/16).

This study complies with the requirements as listed in the Gazetted protocols for impacts on agricultural resources (GN. R 320 of 2020) and minimum report content requirements.

Roy has worked as an agricultural specialist since 2010 and have worked on numerous projects both locally in the Western, Eastern and Northern Cape and Free State as well as internationally in Mozambique, Malawi and Zambia, writing specialist assessments. Some of the more recent agricultural assessments are listed below:

| NAME OF PROJECT                                | DESCRIPTION                                                               | DATE COMPLETED | DETAILS OF CLIENT                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ndlambe Pipeline Upgrade                       | Upgrading various sewerage lines in Port Alfred, EC                       | July 2026      | Hort Couture<br>Warren Lange – 082 464 8339;<br>warren@hortcouture.co.za                                        |
| Potsdam Housing Development                    | Expanding Potsdam Village outside East London, EC                         | June 2026      | Ezendalo Environmental Consultants<br>Ayanda Mativane-Matyeni – 078 827 3985;<br>Ezendalo.environment@gmail.com |
| Carolina Smallholdings and Housing Development | Subdivision of a farm into smallholdings and housing near Keiskamma Mouth | May 2025       | Abantu Environmental<br>Sive Mlamla – 078 207 8278;<br>info@abantuenv ironmental.co.za                          |
| SunRiver Citrus Development                    | New citrus expansion on farm SunRiver near Kirkwood, EC                   | May 2025       | Habitat Link<br>Roberto Almanza – 082 930 8711;<br>roberto@habitatlink.co.za                                    |
| Kou-Kamma Two Rivers Piggery                   | Development of a new commercial piggery in Joubertina, EC                 | March 2025     | Habitat Link<br>Roberto Almanza – 082 930 8711;<br>roberto@habitatlink.co.za                                    |
| Nxele Piggery                                  | Development of a new commercial piggery in Uitenhage, EC                  | April 2025     |                                                                                                                 |

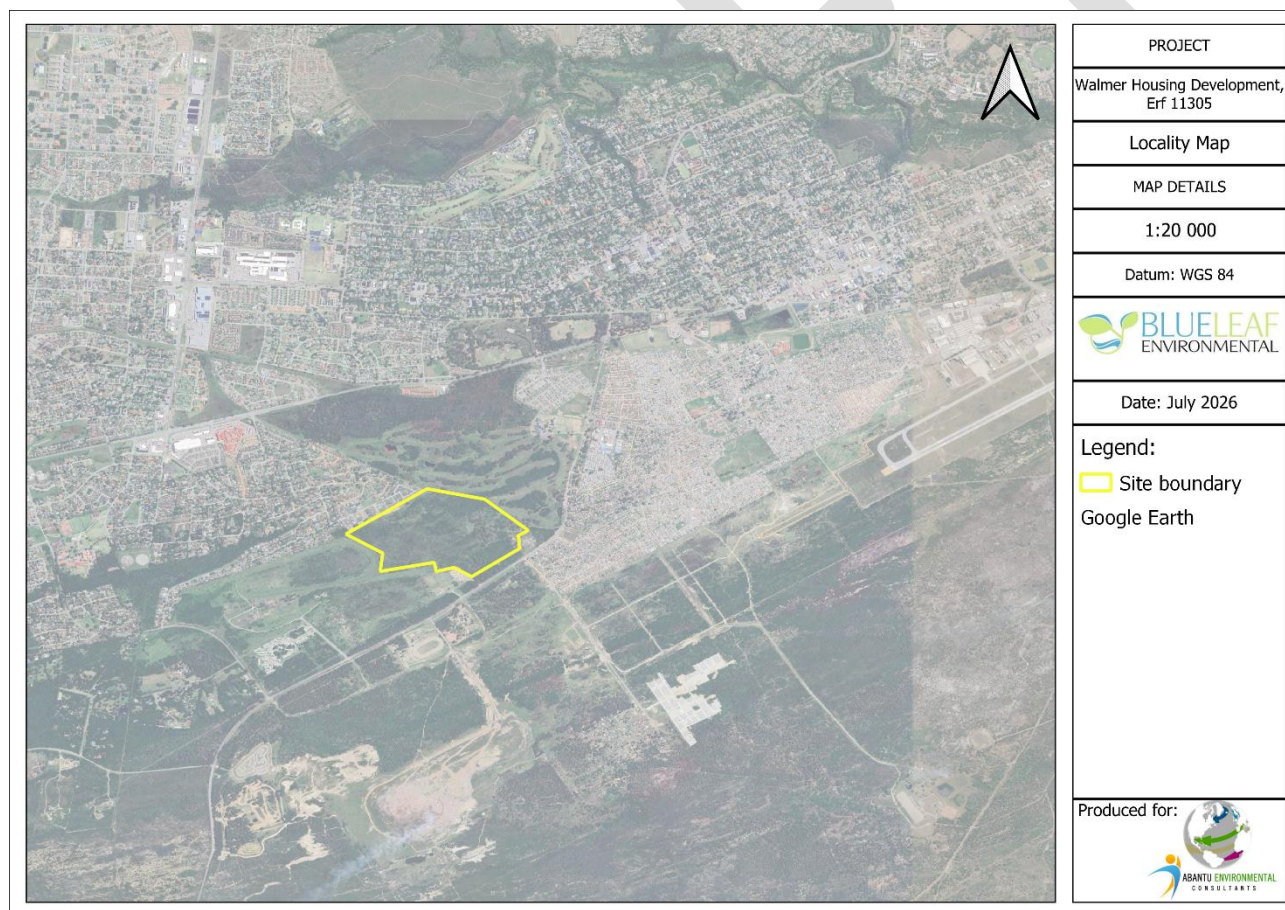
| NAME OF PROJECT            | DESCRIPTION                                                                                        | DATE COMPLETED | DETAILS OF CLIENT                                                      |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Prashanti Poultry          | Development of a new commercial poultry facility in Rocklands, EC                                  | April 2025     | Rafuni (Pty) Ltd<br>Nyakallo – 079 178 8701;<br>geoenviro@rafuni.co.za |
| Sam Piggery                | Development of a new commercial piggery facility in Rocklands, EC                                  | April 2025     |                                                                        |
| Schaapkraal Poultry        | Converting a vegetable farm into poultry in the Phillipi area, WC                                  | March 2025     |                                                                        |
| Thembaletu Mix Agriculture | Formalization of 346 ha farmland to farm vegetables, maize, legumes and livestock near George, WC  | January 2025   |                                                                        |
| Zolani Small Scale Farming | Development of mixed farming in piggery, sheep, goats, chickens etc on various farms in Ashton, WC | March 2025     |                                                                        |

### 3. Introduction

BlueLeaf Environmental Consulting (Pty) Ltd (BlueLeaf) has been appointed by Abantu Environmental Services, on behalf of the Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality (NMBM) to undertake an Agricultural Assessment which forms part of the Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) process conducted by Abantu as regulated by the National Environmental Management Act (No. 107 of 1998) (NEMA, as amended) for the proposed construction of a new housing development in Walmer, Gqeberha in the Eastern Cape Province. As per the legislative requirements, an EIA application must be submitted with the Eastern Cape Department of Economic Development, Environmental Affairs & Tourism (DEDEAT).

#### 3.1 Project description

NMBM is proposing construction of the new Walmer housing development, including associated facilities and infrastructure on Erf 11305, Walmer within the Nelson Mandela Bay Municipality. The erf is located west of the existing Wamer township along Victoria Drive (Figure 3.1).

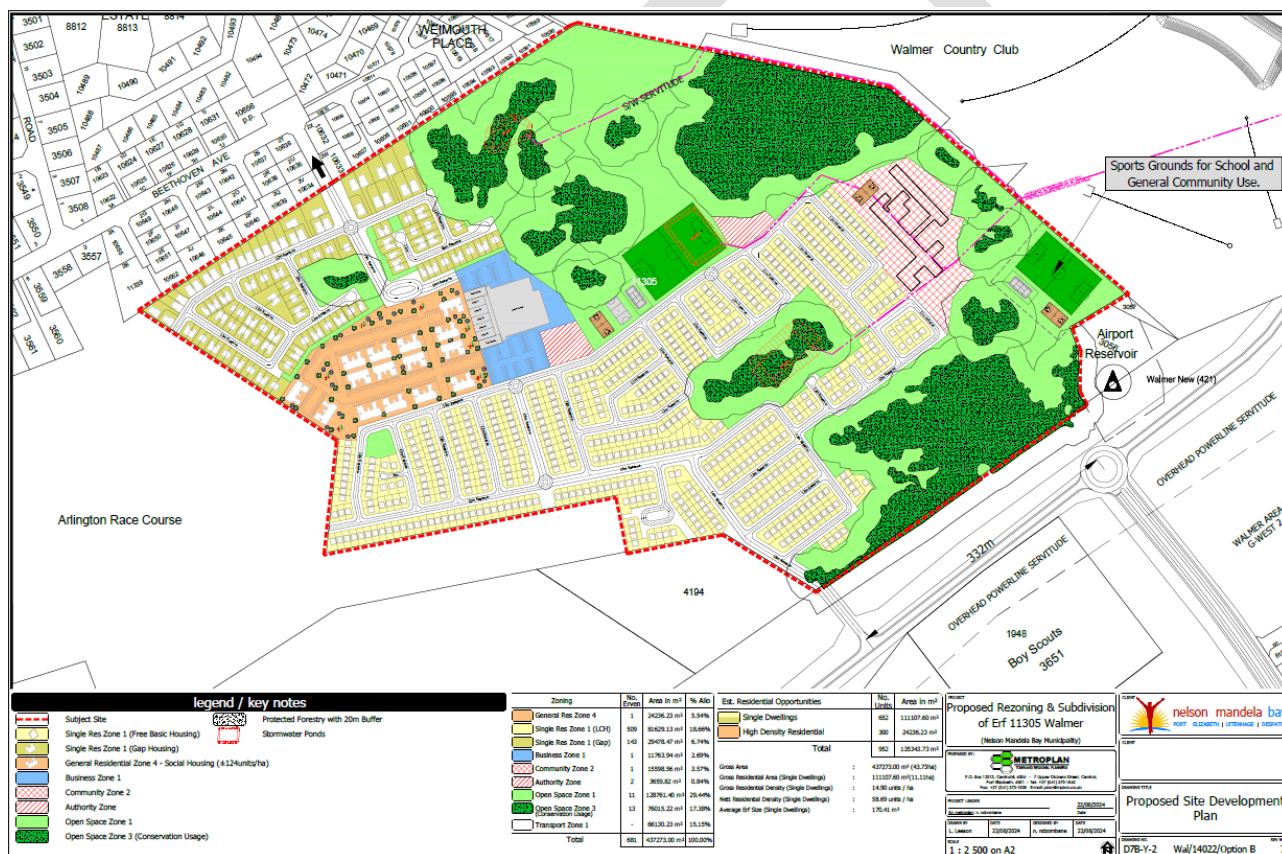


**Figure 3.1: Location of erf 11305 in Walmer, Gqeberha**

The housing development will provide a mix of housing typologies and associated facilities which include the following (Figure 3.2):

- Housing typologies and associated facilities

- Free Basic House/RDP
- GAP/FLISP
- Social Housing
- Open/GAP market housing
- Other land uses
  - Business Zone I- to provide for businesses such as a supermarket, bottle store, service trades etc with parking provision at 3.33 bays per 100m<sup>2</sup>.
  - Institutional Zone I- school site.
  - Authority Zone- authority uses such as police station, fire services, telecommunications facilities etc.
  - Open Space Zone I- public open space.
  - Special use- conservation usage (Forest patches).
  - Transportation Zone II- public Zone.

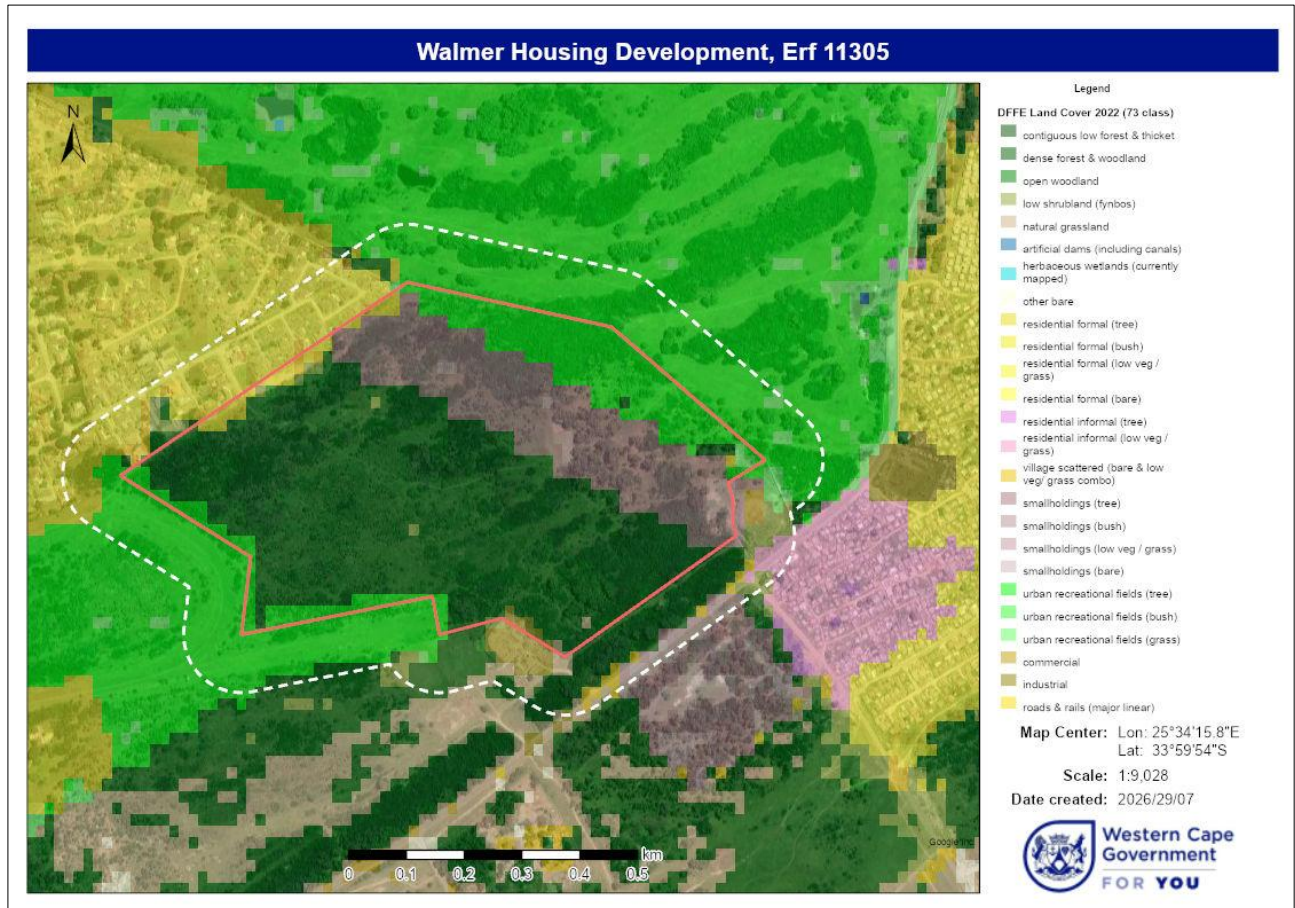


**Figure 3.2: Layout of the proposed Walmer housing project in Gqeberha, Eastern Cape**

The total area of the site is 43.73 ha. The Gross Residential Area (single dwellings) is 11.11 ha with Gross Residential Density (single dwellings) being 14.90 units/ha and a Nett Residential Density (single dwellings) being 58.69 units/ha. The average erf size for single dwellings is 170.41m<sup>2</sup>. No internal infrastructure is currently in place on site; however, electricity, sewer and water will be connected onto existing bulk infrastructure currently servicing the surrounding areas.

### 3.2 Land Cover

A site inspection was conducted on 28 of July 2026. The site is completely covered by natural vegetation with dense contiguous forest and thickets occurring throughout the site interspersed with low vegetation and grass (Figure 3.3).



**Figure 3.3: Land cover map of the study area and surroundings**

Below is a photo sequence of the current land use:

|                                                                                                |                                                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reservoir surrounded by a concrete wall, located east of the site and north of Victoria Drive: | Open grassy areas throughout the site                                                |
|             |  |

Dense thicket vegetation located on Victoria Drive – southeast of the site and southwest of the reservoir – with a shack and an area that is used to sort and burn waste (presumably from the nearby Arlington Waste Facility):



### 3.3 Methodology

This report has been drafted in accordance with the Procedures for the Assessment and Minimum Criteria for Reporting on Identified Environmental Themes in Terms of Sections 24(5)(a) and (h) and 44 of NEMA (G.NR. 1150 of 2020) – ***Protocol for the specialist assessment and minimum report content requirements for environmental impacts on agricultural resources.***

A site sensitivity verification was conducted (see Chapter 5 of this Compliance Statement) to confirm/dispute the current use of the land and agricultural sensitivity as identified by the Screening Tool Report. The Agricultural theme has been identified as “moderate sensitivity”. Motivation, with photographic evidence, will be provided as part of the site sensitivity verification.

Current literature that was used to describe the site includes:

- SANBI National Vegetation Map (2019 as well as updated 2024).
- Soil Classification Working Group, (2018), Soil Classification: A Natural and Anthropogenic System for South Africa, ARC-Institute for Soil, Climate and Water, Pretoria.
- Agricultural potential as determined by soil, terrain, and climate (Schoeman et al; 2000)
- DFFE Screening Report

### 3.4 Assumptions and limitations

1. This compliance statement is based on currently available information and, as a result, limited by the information provided by the Client. Information received included:
  - a. DFFE Screening Tool Report
  - b. Background Information Document (BID)
  - c. All relevant and most recent technical drawings showing completed layouts and technologies proposed.
2. This compliance statement is limited by seasonality as the presented data will be based on a single site survey conducted within a single season (July) of a single year (2026).

## 4. Site analysis

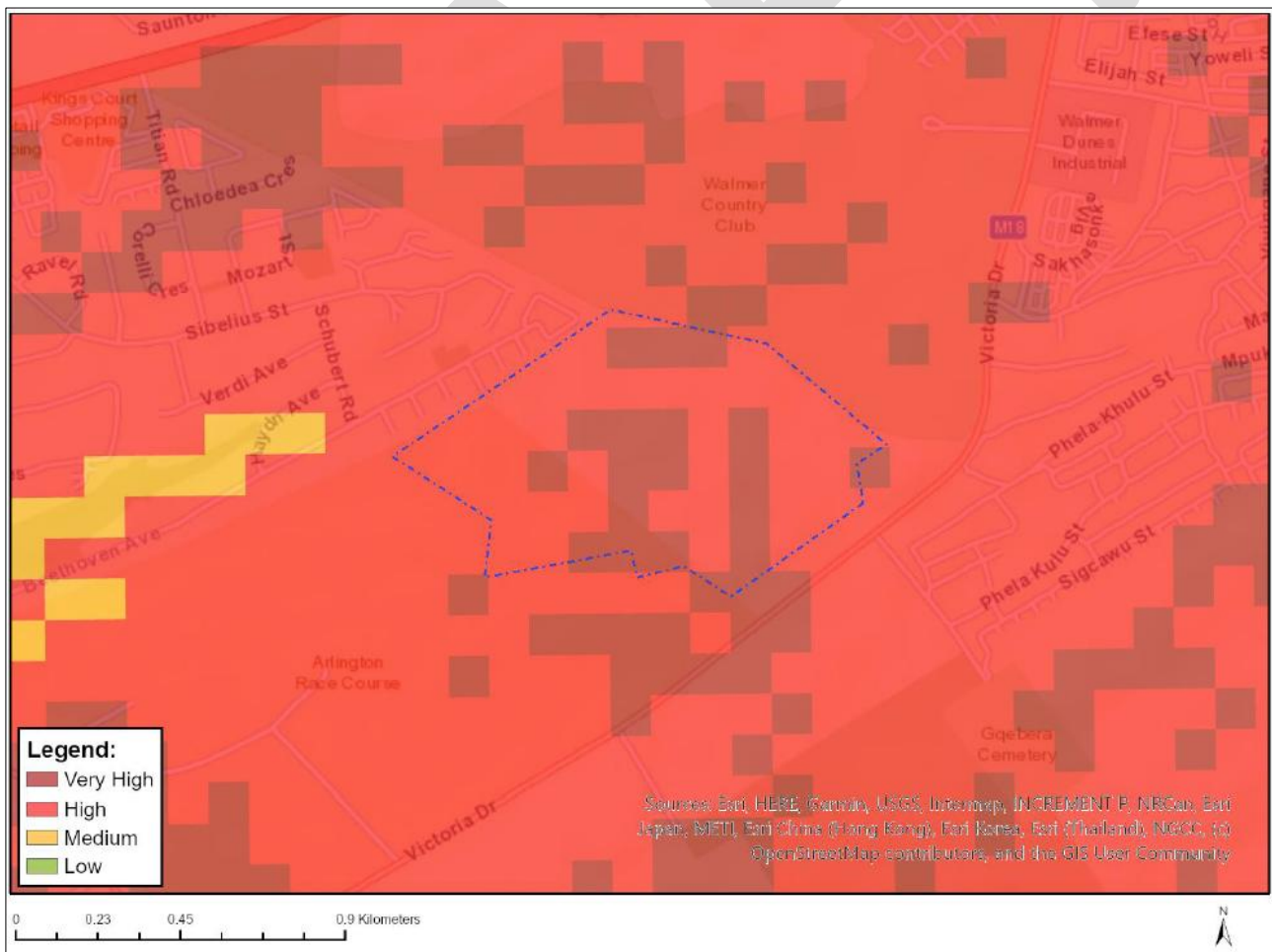
This section was completed prior to the site visit and consist of a desktop analysis of the site based on available literature, plans, and legislation.

### 4.1 Site Sensitivity Verification

According to the protocols specified in GN 1540 (Procedures for the Assessment and Minimum Criteria for Reporting on Identified Environmental Themes in Terms of Sections 24(5)(A) and (H) and 44 of the National Environmental Management Act, 1998, when Applying for Environmental Authorization), assessment and reporting requirements for agriculture are associated with a level of environmental sensitivity identified by the national web-based environmental screening tool (screening tool).

#### Rosehill section:

The screening tool classifies the site as being of a **very high agricultural sensitivity** (Figures 4.1).



**Figure 4.1: Map of the relative agriculture theme sensitivity for erf 11305, Walmer, Gqeberha**

The Screening Tool Report sensitivity allocation is due to the following reasons:

1. Land capability within the boundary range between moderate-high (09) to high (11) classification.

Based on the outcome of the site verification (see section 4 of this report below), the agricultural theme is reduced to low. The land has a high land capability classification indicating that the soil, climate, and terrain are naturally ideal for plant growth. However, this land is unsuitable for agricultural production due to:

- The site is mostly covered by dense natural thicket and forest vegetation in the northeast while open shrubland interspersed with woody alien vegetation dominates most of the site.
- The site is covered by dense housing on the eastern and western boundaries, a golf course in the north and the old Arlington racetrack in the south. As per the NMBM SDF, the racetrack is being reallocated to residences.
- The area lacks access to a reliable water source for irrigation infrastructure; it cannot support intensive agriculture.
- No agricultural infrastructure exists on site.
- The site has never been used for agriculture. Some informal communal grazing occurred.

The agricultural theme was therefore assessed as a Compliance Statement in this report. The agricultural protocols (GN.R. 1150 of 2020) for a compliance statement for the theme were therefore followed.

## 4.2 Vegetation

According to SANBI (Vegetation Map, updated in 2024), the Primary PAOI is located within two vegetation types, namely: **Algoa Sandstone Fynbos (FFs 29)** and **Sardinia Forest Thicket (AT 48)**.

### Algoa Sandstone Fynbos:

Distribution: Eastern Cape Province: Coastal flats at Port Elizabeth from Van Stadens River in the west to Southdene- Summerstrand in the east, located mostly some kilometres from the coast and close to the coast at only Maitland River Mouth and urbanized Summerstrand. Altitude 20–300 m.

Vegetation & Landscape Features: Flat to slightly undulating plain supporting grassy shrubland (mainly graminoid fynbos). Grass has become dominant, especially in wet habitats. In the south this fynbos unit borders on AT 9 Albany Coastal Belt and AZs 1 Algoa Dune Strandveld and forms transitional mosaics with both. It also borders on patches of FOz 6 Southern Coastal Forest in this area.

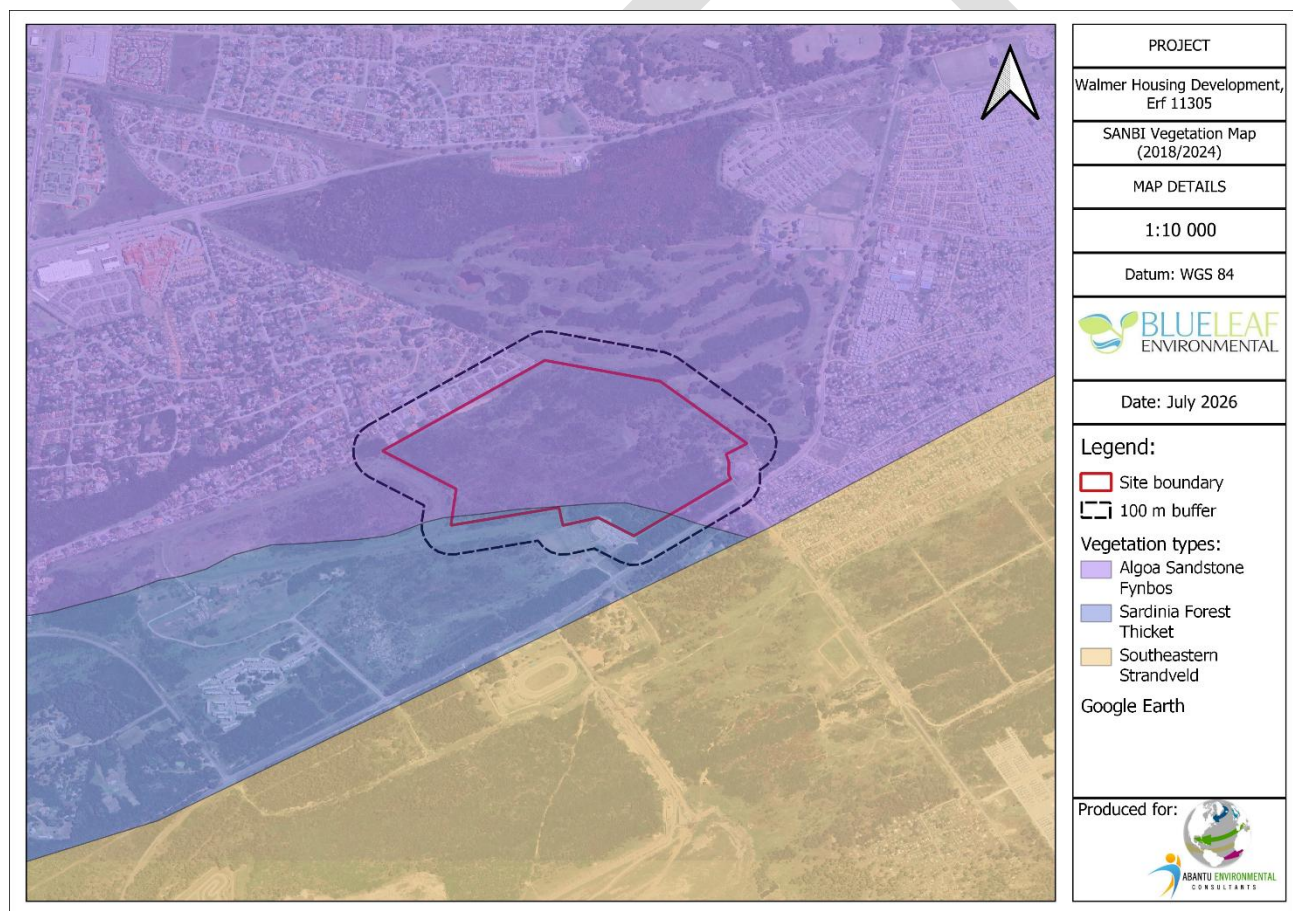
SANBI classifies Algoa Sandstone Fynbos (FFs 29) as Endangered with some of the targeted 23% statutorily conserved in the Van Stadens Wildflower Reserve, The Island Nature Reserve as well as in several private nature reserves. More than 50% transformed (cultivation, urban sprawl of the Nelson Mandela Metropolitan Area). Several Australian Acacia species occur as invasive aliens, but only to a limited extent. Erosion moderate and very low.

### **Sardinia Forest Thicket (AT 48)**

**Distribution:** This vegetation type occurs in the Eastern Cape Province. South-east of Port Elizabeth, forming an arc from Seaview in the west to Walmer Heights in the east, and occurring within 2-5 km of the coast.

**Vegetation & Landscape Features:** Wind- and fire-protected areas on moderately undulating coastal dunes. Medium-sized to tall (3 - 5 m) dense thicket, dominated by small trees and woody shrubs, intergrading with small pockets of tree-dominated (*Ekebergia capensis*, *Erythrina caffra*) coastal forest.

SANBI classifies Sardinia Forest Thicket (AT 48) as Critically Endangered with some of the targeted 19% statutorily conserved in areas not listed. 35.99% transformed due to Cultivation, mining, overgrazing. Erosion low.



**Figure 4.2: SANBI vegetation map of the site and surroundings.**

Patched of dense forest/thicket occur throughout the site. The remainder is a mix of alien trees, shrubs and grassy areas.

### **4.3 Topography**

The project site is located between 105 and 115 m above mean sea level. It appears largely flat in topography – however, the central portion, other than the very localized changes in topography due

to the presence of uneven ground (due to past excavation, mining or dumping of soil, building waste or overburden material).

#### 4.4 Geology and soils

Erf 11305 is primarily underlain by Cenozoic sedimentary deposits of the Algoa Group and extensive mantles of aeolian (wind-blown) sand, often interspersed with localized calcrete hardpan layers.

##### Geology:

- **Algoa Group Sediments:** The area overlies Cenozoic marine and coastal deposits, consisting of calcareous sandstones, shelly limestones, and conglomerates.
- **Calcrete Horizons:** Groundwaters rich in calcium carbonate dissolve shell fragments within the sandy substrate, precipitating out cream-colored hard calcrete layers underground.
- **Topography and Depth:** The terrain is gently sloping toward the east at elevations roughly 100 to 145 meters above sea level, with deep sedimentary overburden hiding older bedrock

##### Soils:

- **Sandy Textures:** Soils are predominantly sandy, shallow to moderately deep red-brown or greyish-brown loams and coarse sandy soils.
- **Nutrient Status:** Typical of coastal dune and marine-derived mantles, the upper soil profiles are generally acidic, well-drained, and low in inherent fertility.
- **Geotechnical and Groundwater Notes:** Localized high iron concentrations in the groundwater and subsurface soil matrices are documented in parts of the Walmer and Walmer Heights sectors.

#### 4.5 Land capability

Most of Walmer in Gqeberha features urbanized land capability with low agricultural potential, designated primarily for residential, commercial, and mixed-use development.

##### Urban and Land Use Characteristics:

- **Built Environment:** Fully integrated urban fabric with established residential neighbourhoods like Upper Walmer, commercial nodes, and major transport links like the M4 and R102.
- **Development Potential:** Zoned for urban infill, commercial properties, and multi-use residential cluster projects.
- **Agricultural Constraints:** Low agricultural capability index typical of coastal metro sub-regions, restricting primary soil usage to non-arable or urban development layouts rather than farming.

Land capability is used to determine agricultural potential of an area and is based on 3 factors namely soil types, terrain form and climate. These factors were applied to confirm/dispute agricultural sensitivity of the proposed pipeline sections only. All land outside the indicated development footprint were excluded as it will not be impacted by the proposed development.

| Factors determining land capability | Outcome                                              | Updated sensitivity allocation |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Climate                             | Bimodal rainfall with favourable climate conditions. | 8 (Moderate)                   |
| Terrain form                        | Flat coastland and steep escarpments                 | 8 (Moderate)                   |
| Soils                               | Mostly well drained sandy coastal soils              | 6 (Low-moderate)               |

## **5. Site sensitivity verification**

---

A site visit was conducted on 28 July 2026, and the entire project site as shown in Figure 3.1 was assessed. The following was found:

- No agricultural land (cropland, rangelands or pastures) will be directly impacted by the proposed development.
- No supporting agricultural infrastructure exists on site or nearby.
- Agricultural sensitivity is considered as low.

Based on the above, it is the opinion of the specialist the proposed housing development on erf 11305 in Walmer, Gqeberha will NOT require a full Agricultural Assessment. No mitigations are proposed.

## 6. Reference

---

ACOCKS, J.P.H. 1953, 1988. Veld types of South Africa. Memoir of the Botanical Survey of South Africa 57: 1-146.

COATES-PALGRAVE, K & COATES-PALGRAVE, M. 2003. Trees of southern Africa. 3rd edition. Struik, Cape Town.

DRIVER, M., RAIMONDO, D., MAZE, K., PFAB, M.F. AND HELME, N.A. 2009. APPLICATIONS OF THE RED LIST FOR CONSERVATION PRACTITIONERS. IN: D. RAIMONDO, L. VON STADEN, W. FODEN, J.E. VICTOR, N.A. HELME, R.C. TURNER, D.A. KAMUNDI AND P.A. MANYAMA (EDS). Red List of South African Plants. Strelitzia 25:41-52. South African National Biodiversity Institute, Pretoria.

FOOD AND AGRICULTURAL ORGANIZATION'S (FAO) (2006) Guidelines of Soil Description. 4th Ed.

GERMISHUIZEN, G. & MEYER, N.L. (Eds). 2003. Plants of southern Africa: an annotated checklist. Strelitzia 14. NBI, Pretoria.

GIBBS RUSSELL, G.E. et al. 1990. Grasses of southern Africa. Memoir of the Botanical Survey of South Africa 58: 1 – 437.

IUCN. 2012. Red List of Threatened Species. IUCN Species Survival Commission, Cambridge Available: <http://www.iucnredlist.org/> (Accessed 03/03/2017).

LOW, A & REBELO, A. 1998. Vegetation of South Africa, Lesotho and Swaziland. Department of Environmental Affairs & Tourism, Pretoria.

MUCINA, L. & RUTHERFORD, M.C. 2012. The vegetation of South Africa, Lesotho and Swaziland. SANBI, Pretoria.

NEM:BA. 2014. National Environmental Management Act: Biodiversity Act (No. 10 of 2004) – Alien and Invasive Species lists, 2014. Government Gazette, No. 37320, 12 February 2014.

NFA. 1998. National Forests Act (No. 84 of 1998).

SCHOEMAN, J.L., VAN DER WALT, M., MONNIK, K.A., THACKRAH, A., MALHERBE, J. AND LE ROUX, R.E., 2000. The development and application of a land capability classification system for South Africa. ARC-ISCW Report No GW/A/2000/57, ARC-Institute for Soil, Climate and Water, Pretoria

Smith, B. 2006. The Farming Handbook. Netherlands & South Africa: University of KwaZulu-Natal Press & CTA.

SOIL CLASSIFICATION WORKING GROUP. 2018. Soil Classification: A Natural and Anthropogenic System for South Africa, ARC-Institute for Soil, Climate and Water, Pretoria

VAN OUDTSHOORN, F. 1999. Guide to grasses of southern Africa. Briza, Pretoria.